

# STEPHEN SOOKRA

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## EDUCATION

### Kennesaw State University

Kennesaw, GA

*B.S. in Computer Science, Concentration in Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning*

*Expected May 2028*

- GPA: 3.8/4.0 | 4× Dean's List

## EXPERIENCE

### Software Engineer Intern

Mar 2026 – Present

*XR Dojo*

*Atlanta, GA*

- Build and ship gameplay features for *ATL Quest*, an AR mobile game in Unity (C#) targeting XR headsets and mobile.
- Prototype a React migration path for the game's frontend to enable cross-platform reach, working across engineering, design, and creative.

### Founder & Project Lead

Jan 2026 – Present

*Nest (Non-Profit Initiative)*

*Atlanta, GA*

- Founded an AI navigator generating 90-day benefits, housing, and education plans for aging-out Georgia foster youth.
- Partnered with KSU ASCEND for institutional validation and lived-experience usability testing; advised by Dr. Richard Gesick.
- Selected for the KSU CCSE Spring 2026 Computing Showcase (C-Day) as project UC-151-197 (Undergraduate category).

### Data Analyst — HBCU Data for Good

Apr 2026

*JPMorganChase*

*Plano, TX*

- Selected as 1 of 100 participants from 800+ applicants for JPMorganChase's HBCU Data for Good program.
- Led EDA across 6 HUD datasets (73,000+ census tracts) and built a weighted scikit-learn model ranking 357 Tarrant County neighborhoods for the Fort Worth Community Land Trust.
- Integrated FEMA flood zones, OpenStreetMap, and Census TIGER shapefiles; presented results to the nonprofit's executives.

### Teaching Assistant

Summer 2026 (Upcoming)

*SMASH Academy*

*Atlanta, GA*

- Selected as a TA at Morehouse and Spelman; teach Python, JavaScript, and project-based web/game development to underrepresented high-school scholars.

## PROJECTS

### Trace | Python, FastAPI, SapBERT, Actian VectorAI DB | [Live Demo](#)

Apr 2026

- Built a semantic search engine bridging families' descriptions of missing persons and unidentified-remains forensic records ("eagle tattoo" → "avian motif dermagraphic").
- Engineered a hybrid vector-search pipeline with SapBERT embeddings and named vectors over 40,000+ records in the federal NamUs database.
- **Won 1st Place** out of 22 teams at the Actian Build Challenge #1.

### StepSafe | TensorFlow, MobileNetV2, FastAPI, React, Vite | [Live Demo](#)

Mar 2026

- Built a web app that classifies diabetic foot ulcers from images, returning severity scores and clinical recommendations.
- Trained and fine-tuned MobileNetV2 on ~20,000 annotated foot-ulcer images to produce per-image severity classifications.
- **Won 1st Place** at the HMI Hackathon 2026 (Open Innovation track), KSU.

### PyroLens | React, Vite, FastAPI, scikit-learn, ESP32, Supabase | [Live Demo](#)

Mar 2026

- Built a real-time dashboard with live IoT sensor data, prescribed-burn readiness scoring, and ML-backed burn-window predictions.
- Integrated NOAA weather, Sentinel Hub NDVI satellite imagery, and NASA FIRMS fire-detection APIs.
- **Won 2nd Place** (Assurant) and **3rd Place** (Capgemini Net Positive AI) at the KSU Hackathon for Social Good.

### Saber | Next.js, React, TypeScript, OpenAI, Web Speech API | [Live Demo](#)

Apr 2026

- Built an AI diagnostic tool for English Language Learners that separates language barriers from knowledge gaps, telling "doesn't understand the concept" apart from "doesn't understand the English."
- Led the frontend (Next.js, React, Tailwind) with Web Speech API voice input, JWT auth, and an OpenAI-backed classify/translate layer over a full-stack deployment.
- **Won 3rd Place** at Vibra ATL 2026 (SHPE Hackathon), Georgia State University.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Languages:** Python, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, C++, C#, Swift, Ruby

**Frameworks & Libraries:** React, React Native, FastAPI (REST APIs), TensorFlow, scikit-learn, Pandas, NumPy, OpenCV, spaCy, Unity

**Developer Tools:** Git, GitHub, GitLab, Firebase, Supabase, Expo, Google Colab, Jupyter, Figma

**Concepts:** Machine Learning, NLP, Computer Vision, Data Structures & Algorithms, Agile

## CERTIFICATIONS

**CodePath** — Intro to Web Development (WEB101), Spring 2026

**Wells Fargo × The Global Career Accelerator** — Early Talent Competition (Top 2 of 4,700+ students)

**AT&T Technology Academy 2025** — Network troubleshooting, 5G strategy, and cloud computing fundamentals

**Anthropic Academy 2026** — AI Fluency, Claude 101, Claude Code 101, Claude API, Model Context Protocol, Agent Skills

**Udacity × AWS** — AWS AI Practitioner Challenge, 2026

## AWARDS & ACHIEVEMENTS

**Hackathon Podium Finisher — 7 top-3 finishes across 6 events (15+ hackathons entered).**

**1st** — Actian Build Challenge #1 (Trace) · **1st** — HMI Hackathon 2026 (StepSafe) · **2nd** — Wells Fargo × GCA Early Talent Competition (SafeHaven) · **2nd** — KSU Social Good / Assurant (PyroLens) · **3rd** — KSU Social Good / Capgemini (PyroLens) · **3rd** — KSU FinTech 2025 (EchoPay) · **3rd** — Vibra ATL 2026 / SHPE (Saber)